

metaphor

A word or phrase that is used to describe something as if it were something else.

misplaced modifier

A modifier that has been placed so far from the person or thing it is intended to modify that it appears to modify a different person or thing.

modal auxiliary verb

An auxiliary verb such as *could* that is used with an action verb to express a command, an obligation, or a possibility.

morpheme

The smallest meaningful part of a word.

noun

A part of speech that refers to a person, place, or thing.

noun phrase

Several words that, when grouped together, perform the same function as a noun.

number

The term used to identify a noun or pronoun as singular or plural.

object

The person or thing (a noun or pronoun) that is receiving the action of the verb.

objective

When a piece of writing is not influenced by the writer's personal opinions.

onomatopoeia

The use of words that mimic the sounds they represent.

opinion

A statement based on someone's personal view.

ordinal number

The form of a number that includes *first*, *second*, *tenth*, and *twenty-first*.

participle

The form of a verb that ends in -ing (present participle) or -ed or -en (past participle).

passive voice

When the subject in a sentence is receiving the action of the verb, and the object is performing it. It is formed using the auxiliary verb *be* and the past participle.

past participle

The form of a verb that usually ends in -ed or -en. It is used with the auxiliary verbs *have* and *will* to form the perfect tenses, and with the auxiliary verb *be* to form the passive voice.

personal pronoun

A pronoun such as *she* that takes the place of a noun and represents people, places or things.

personification

When human actions or feelings are given to objects or ideas.

pitch

The height of a sound.

plural noun

When more than one person or thing is being described.

possessive determiner

A word that is used before a noun to show ownership.

predicate position

When an adjective follows a linking verb at the end of a sentence.

prefix

A group of letters attached to the start of a word that can change the original word's meaning.

prepositional phrasal verb

A verb followed by a preposition, which together act as a single unit to describe an action.

prepositional phrase

A preposition followed by a noun, pronoun, or noun phrase that together act as an adjective (describing a noun) or an adverb (describing a verb) in a sentence.

present participle

The form of a verb that ends in -ing. It is used with the auxiliary verb *be* to form the continuous tenses.

pronoun

A word, such as *I*, *some*, or *who* that takes the place of a noun.

proper noun

The name given to a particular person, place, or thing, which always starts with a capital letter.